

DEADLY VENOM

All sea snakes aside from sea kraits are true marine reptiles because they never return to land. They even breed at sea, giving birth to live young in the water. Their venomous bite is incredibly powerful—far more deadly than a cobra's. This is because they need it to catch fish, which could easily swim away if not killed instantly.



▲ **YELLOW-BELLIED SEA SNAKE**
The yellow-bellied sea snake is found in the Indian and Pacific oceans. It hunts during the day, preying on small fish.

SEA-GOING LIZARDS

Some big tropical monitor lizards may swim out to sea to reach other shores. But the only lizard that is specialized for ocean life is the marine iguana of the Galápagos Islands. It eats seaweed, which it gathers from submerged rocks. The sea around the islands is chilled by the cold Peru Current, so when the iguana emerges from the water, it often spends a long time basking in the sunshine to warm up.



► **MARINE IGUANA**
The fierce-looking marine iguanas normally have dark skin, but males glow with vivid colors in the breeding season.

Long claws for clinging on to rocks

COAST AND SEASHORE



CARING PARENT

Widespread across Central America from the Pacific coast to the eastern Caribbean, the American crocodile has special adaptations that allow it to live in saltwater.

This helps the crocodile to hunt in both freshwater and shallow tropical seas. Like all crocodiles, it lays eggs on land. It buries them in a mound of sand on a river bank, and relies on the tropical climate to keep them warm, so that they develop and hatch.

► **AMERICAN CROCODILE**
American crocodiles lie in wait for hours, ready to ambush prey. They feed mainly on fish, but also use their powerful jaws to crush turtle shells.



DEADLY PREDATOR

The fearsome saltwater crocodile hunts in rivers and along coasts. It often targets land mammals that have waded into shallow water, dragging them under to drown. Found in southeast Asia and Australia, saltwater crocodiles have also colonized a number of small islands in the south Pacific; some have even reached as far as Japan.

◀ **SALTWATER CROCODILE**
This young male saltwater crocodile can grow to at least 23 ft (7 m) long. During its lifetime, its long, sharp teeth are constantly replaced.

WOW!

A saltwater crocodile can kill and eat an animal the size of a water buffalo—but it will not need to eat again for six months or more.